



For federal workers, shutdown is last straw

After months of hassle and indignities, some say ‘there is no hope’

BY HANNAH NATANSON, OLIVIA GEORGE AND MERYL KORNFELD

President Donald Trump’s second term had already brought misery to the nation’s 2.1 million civilian federal workers: unprecedented mass layoffs, strict return-to-office requirements and more red tape regulating everything from travel to printer paper.

Now, with the government shut down, 750,000 federal staffers have been furloughed and many others are working without pay, even as Trump and his top lieutenants vow to put more federal jobs on the chopping block.

“When did we become the enemy?” said one National Institutes of Health employee who, like other workers interviewed for this article, spoke on the condition of anonymity for fear of retaliation. Her husband, who retired from the NIH this year, could not answer.

“Why are we the enemy?” he asked.

More than 80 federal employees across three dozen agencies described the shutdown, and the spreading fear of layoffs, as the

SEE SHUTDOWN ON A8

Trump learns from the last time: Sees tool to cut staff, target foes. **A8**

Democrats’ shutdown defiance: Gloves off against president. **A10**

Conservative poised to be Japan’s first female leader

Fourth prime minister in five years would pull country sharply to right

BY MICHELLE YE HEE LEE AND CHIE TANAKA

Sanae Takaichi, a hard-line conservative security hawk, is set to become Japan’s new — and first female — prime minister, taking the helm of the country with the world’s fourth-largest economy at a time of unusual political instability, rising prices and increasing tensions in the Asia-Pacific region.

Takaichi, a 64-year-old newscaster turned politician who has served in top government positions, on Saturday defeated four other candidates — all men — to win the leadership of the ruling Liberal Democratic Party (LDP). This is her third run at the party leadership post.

She is poised to become prime minister later this month, succeeding Shigeru Ishiba, who last month announced he would step down after less than a year in the role, following two crushing parliamentary defeats that cost the long-governing ruling LDP its coalition majority in both legislative chambers. She would be the fourth prime minister in five years.

Takaichi, a nationalist, would pull Japan’s politics sharply to

SEE JAPAN ON A16

Violent clashes erupt in Chicago over ICE crackdown

BY KIM BELLWARE, TIM CRAIG, JOSHUA LOTT AND GAYA GUPTA

CHICAGO — President Donald Trump on Saturday authorized the activation of 300 National Guard troops in this city against the Illinois governor’s wishes. The orders came after heavily armed federal agents shot a woman, sparking further clashes between immigration authorities and angry residents.

A federal judge separately barred Trump from sending National Guard troops to Portland, where protesters and federal law enforcement were facing off outside an Immigration and Customs Enforcement facility. The rapidly unfolding events in both cities represented an escalation

WOMAN IS SHOT BY ‘BOXED IN’ AGENTS

Trump authorizes Guard over Pritzker’s objections

of weeks of tension between local residents and officials and the Trump administration.

Department of Homeland Security spokeswoman Tricia McLaughlin said federal agents shot the woman in Chicago during immigration enforcement operations in the city’s Brighton Park neighborhood.

The agents fired “defensive shots” after “officers were rammed by vehicles and boxed in by 10 cars,” McLaughlin said in a statement. The woman, who was

a U.S. citizen but not identified, drove herself to a nearby hospital and was later taken into custody by the FBI, according to DHS.

The Washington Post could not immediately verify the sequence of events.

The Chicago Police Department said officers were called to the scene after the shooting, but declined to comment on the incident, saying that federal authorities are handling the investigation into the shooting.

The shooting occurred a few hours before Illinois Gov. JB Pritzker, a Democrat, said in a statement that the Trump administration has issued him an “ultimatum” that state National

SEE CHICAGO ON A6

In Portland: Judge temporarily bars Trump from deploying troops. **A10**



JOSHUA LOTT/THE WASHINGTON POST

Chicago Alderman Byron Sigcho-Lopez is treated Saturday in Brighton Park, where federal agents used chemical irritants.



EBRAHIM HAJAJ/REUTERS

A Palestinian man looks at the damage to a neighborhood in Gaza City on Saturday following an Israeli operation. Attacks continued well into Saturday after Hamas on Friday conditionally accepted a ceasefire deal. Israel said it had ordered a “reduction in the level of fire.”

Among U.S. Jews, a wide rebuke of Israel’s conduct

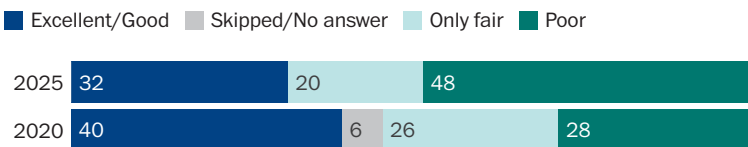
BY NAFTALI BENDAVID, SCOTT CLEMENT AND EMILY GUSKIN

Many American Jews sharply disapprove of Israel’s conduct of the war in Gaza, with 61 percent saying Israel has committed war crimes and about 4 in 10 saying the country is guilty of genocide against the Palestinians, according to a Washington Post poll.

The findings are striking given the long-standing ties between the U.S. Jewish community and Israel, suggesting the potential for a historic breach over the Gaza war. Two years after Hamas militants poured into Israel on Oct. 7, 2023, killing some 1,200 people

American Jews are much more critical of Benjamin Netanyahu’s leadership than in 2020

Q: Overall, how would you rate Benjamin Netanyahu’s leadership of Israel?



Source: Sept. 2-9, 2025, Washington Post poll of 815 Jewish Americans with a margin of sampling error of +/- 4.7 percentage points. Nov. 19, 2019, to June 3, 2020, Pew Research Center poll of 4,718 Jewish Americans with a margin of error of 3 points.

EMILY GUSKIN / THE WASHINGTON POST

In Gaza: Palestinians have hope for ceasefire plan, but doubts remain. **A15**

and taking 250 hostage, Israel’s retaliatory incursion has killed more than 67,000 Palestinians, according to the Gaza Health Ministry — which does not distinguish between combatants and civilians but says the majority of the dead are women and children — displaced many more, and led to widespread hunger in the territory.

American Jews are particularly unhappy with the current Israeli government. Sixty-eight percent give negative marks to Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu’s leadership of Israel, with 48 percent rating it “poor” — a 20-percentage-point jump from a Pew Research

SEE POLL ON A14

Billionaire Trump ally, son forging unrivaled empire of old and new media

BY CAROLINE O’DONOVAN AND WILL OREMUS

Journalists at CBS News reeled on Friday as they digested news reports that opinion journalist Bari Weiss, a fierce critic of the mainstream media, would become the editor in chief of the straitlaced legacy brand.

Two months earlier, there had been cautious optimism in the

Midtown Manhattan newsroom, according to two CBS News staffers who spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss private information. Movie producer David Ellison, son of software billionaire Larry Ellison, dropped by to introduce himself as the chief executive of Paramount Skydance, the company that now owned CBS after an \$8 billion merger that promised new in-

vestment.

But the newsroom hasn’t heard directly from Ellison since that day, leaving many apprehensive about plans for the network, the two staffers said. The anxiety has been reinforced in recent weeks as details of Weiss’s likely hire — and Paramount Skydance’s \$150 million acquisition of her online publication, the Free Press — leaked in media

outlets ahead of internal confirmation.

The deal and new role for Weiss are the latest moves by David Ellison as he builds a media empire alongside his Silicon Valley tycoon father. Through pivotal deals negotiated or approved by President Donald Trump and his appointees in recent months, the Ellisons have assembled an unprecedented ar-

ray of old and new media.

Larry Ellison, 81, is the second-richest person in the world and co-founder and chairman of tech company Oracle, which is set to own a piece of the U.S. spin-off of TikTok, according to two people familiar with the negotiations. David Ellison, 42, made blockbusters including “Top Gun: Maverick” at his Hollywood com-

SEE ELLISON ON A17

SPORTS

Terps blow 20-0 second-half lead, are stunned by Washington, 24-20. **B1**

BUSINESS

A mine raises fears over Minnesota’s pristine Boundary Waters. **B11**



BOOK WORLD

A new novel revisits the torturous affair that inspired “Frankenstein.”

METRO

The chief judge in D.C. admonishes Pirro’s office to be civil. **B18**



ARTS & STYLE

Rasika’s palak chaat, left, just made a top-five list for Tom Sietsema.

TRAVEL

Is Albania another Italy or Greece minus the crowds and high prices?

\$330 SUNDAY COUPON INSERTS

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